

William Schmidt, RHP, LSU

2026 Stats: 4.22 ERA/1.328 WHIP/64 IP/85 K/31 BB/2.74 K:BB

6-4, 201

Metrics

FB: 95.3/19.1 IVB/9.8 HB/-4.89 VAA/6 ext/6.5 relH/51.4 AA/45.1% zone/44.3% usage/2370 rpm

CB: 79.9/-10.5 IVB/-3.8 HB/-10.03 VAA/52.6 AA/29.8% zone/10.9% usage/2750 rpm

SL: 85.5/-0.4 IVB/-1.8 HB/-8.44 VAA/50.2 AA/32.3% zone/44.7% usage/2660 rpm

CH: 83.9/12.8 IVB/10.5 HB/NA VAA/50.2 AA/0% zone/0.1% usage/1510 rpm

Write-up

Schmidt is part of the same touted Tiger's recruiting class as Casan Evans and may be the higher upside arm looking forward into the 2027 draft. A tall RHP that looks to have more filling in to do looking forward, Schmidt throws a power riding FB with two intriguing breakers from a high release. He struggled to throw strikes consistently at times, running into 31 walks this season, but the punchout stuff is undeniable with his 12 K/9. If Schmidt is able to harness the command a bit, he can turn into a solid mid rotation starter in the pros.

The FB from Schmidt possesses elite ride and showed carry through the zone despite the high release point. He sits 4-6 with the pitch, touching 99 on the season. He zoned the pitch well, but the spray chart suggests more middle tendencies than shadow and the pitch was swung at an enormous amount in zone without much whiff there. He threw the FB down and in too often to LHH and they hit .300 off the heater through the season. To righties, he was better at getting the FB up and they only hit .206 off the heater. Bringing the fastball to the upper half against lefties would help the pitches ride play up and focusing on the outer half as well would help, as that is where Schmidt got his whiffs. 50/55 pitch
The CB was the pitch that awed scouts coming out of high school but has taken a backseat slightly in college ball in Baton Rouge. The pitch is heavy with big spin and downward bite and he holds his release point well. He gets it down but struggled to bury the pitch in putaway situations, leading to only 12 total whiffs and a poor 14% chase rate. What the pitch did well was generate CS at about a 20%

clip on the season. It is a pure 12-6 and is a pretty pitch when he lands it for strikes, but the bury target was overly spiked and simply non competitive. The command needs to be refined so that he can use it as a true out pitch vs LHH and as a third pitch to keep hitters more honest. 45/55 pitch

The SL is the hallmark of the arsenal, a hard gyro that gets to elite depth and is very steep to the bottom of the zone. The tight spin got lots of uncomfortable whiffs at a 52% rate and 22% SWSTR for 119 total whiffs. He will back it up and leave it at the top of the zone, but when there he got more CS than hard contact. The 31% putaway rate showed how good Schmidt is at using the pitch to put hitters away and locate it down and glove side. He ran the pitch into the low 80s consistently and it truly has plus stuff. The command can of course be refined, such as learning how to execute the backdoor to lefties. 60/70 pitch